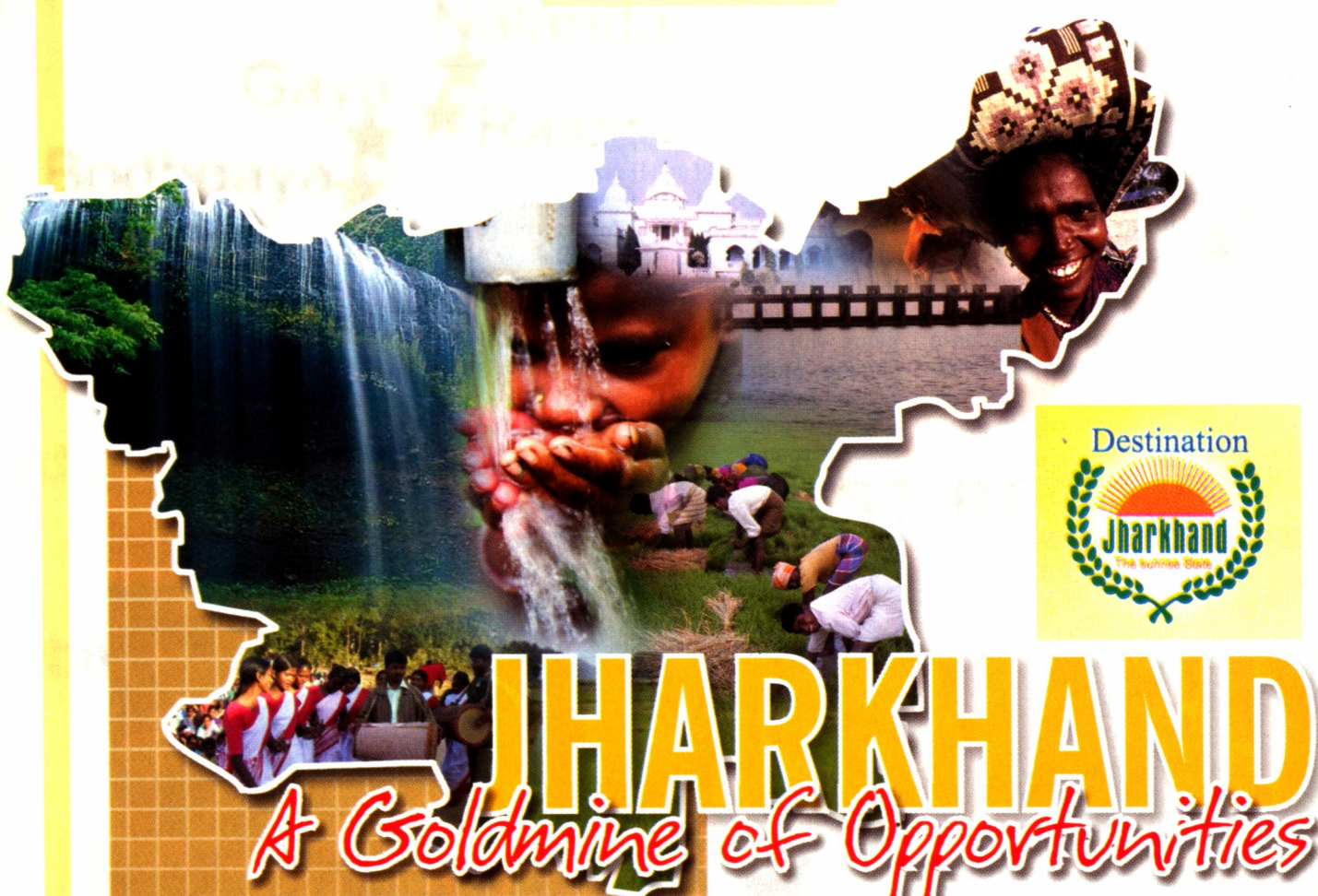




Lush green forests and the serene tunes of tribal music wafting in the air greet you in Jharkhand.. The newest state of the Republic of India, created on the 15th of November, in the year 2000, it is also the richest State in terms of mineral resources and forestry, housing 1/3rd share of the country's entire mineral resources. Even a third of the country's total coal comes from Jharkhand. It is a storehouse of immense possibilities waiting to be tapped ■

Jharkhand has been in the news for other reasons lately. The state has attracted the attention of the masses in the country by giving it Mahendra Singh Dhoni, the Indian cricket captain, who brought home the coveted Twenty-Twenty World Cup. The success of Dhoni has given sports a new thrust in the State. Jharkhand will be the host of the next National games in 2008.

And while cricket remains a passion here, over 2.38 million hectares of land of the State is forested with a variety of wildlife. Therefore, courtesy its rich pool of natural beauty, mineral resources, and manpower, it can actually be called "The state of opportunity". It is full of potential which are awaiting development. What's more, the government is proactively making provisions and development schemes, which are investor friendly. The major thrust areas for the Government are Mining, Industry and Tourism. It is an ideal time to come and explore this land. Here's what Jharkhand has in store:

■ MINING: TAPPING NEW GROUNDS

Out of the total iron resources in the country, 32 per cent is found in Jharkhand itself. Other than that, 26 per cent of Copper Ore, 91 per cent Pyrite and 58 per cent graphite of the total resources in the country lie in Jharkhand. The state also has substantial Limestone and Bauxite reserves.

Already, the state is attracting major investors. The huge Iron Ore reserves have caught the attention and interest of steel giants such as Arcelor-Mittal, Tata Steel, Jindal Steel, and others. The Jindals are planning to set up a unit with the capacity of 5 million tonnes, near Patratu. The State